driven to mere existence. All efforts centered on preserving its identity, allying all social customs and behavior completely to its religions, which remained the only common bond among the Indians.

Then the caste (as distinct from the *varṇa)* system of India became rigid. Enslaved Hindus, with no education or freedom of the spirit, found it easier to take up and grow in the profession of their fathers and forefathers. To try to do anything new, or to seek new careers, would have been not only too hazardous but practically impossible. All those professions which continued as hereditary became *jātis,* castes, and each caste took to social relationships between its own group in inter-dining and intermarrying. There came to exist some 3,000 castes based on occupation.

Along with this, it was natural that ideas of hierarchy were introduced. The *brāhmaṇas,* being responsible for religious ceremonies and the reciting of the sacred *mantras* (hymns) and being the only literate men, were still at the top, and at the bottom came the practitioners of the dirty work of cleaning the latrines or dealing with the skins of dead animals, etc. Since personal cleanliness was a surviving heritage, it gave rise to ideas of pollution and untouchability. The learned kept reading and studying ancient texts and copying manuscripts even in this age, but the people at large were practically living animals under their own religious beliefs, devoid of all spirit of dignity and of free inquiry and criticism.

The caste system, all sorts of discrimination, restrictions on widow marriage, forced *satī,* slavery, early marriage, etc., spread on grounds of sheer survival. These are not the social thoughts and practices of civilized India in its period of glory; these are the survivals of a dead India in itself unfree and slave.

CONTEMPORARY INDIA

The new India wants to eradicate these evils as quickly as possible. They do not represent the living India, which has come to breathe its own air again only recently, though India had always been looking backward to its earlier period, the *"Sat-Yuga,"* the period of truth, justice, and freedom. As India became a political unity and free once more after centuries of political slavery, her freedom of spirit revived. The evils of India are not representative or characteristic theories of the status of the individual in society, but abominations attempted, at a critical period, in defense of India's